

virtuoso pianism, and attaining near-adulation.

Marie's unhappiness at the composer's protracted absences meant that the couple drifted apart; and Liszt's relentless performing schedule allowed little time for him to compose. In 1847, following a concert in Kiev, he met the Ukrainian princess Carolyne Sayn-Wittgenstein, a married woman with a young daughter. Again, an instant attraction was deepened—this time, by a shared Catholic faith. Liszt abandoned his life as a traveling pianist and moved to Weimar with Carolyne and her daughter, Marie. There he became Kapellmeister in Extraordinary, a post created for him by Weimar's ruler, Grand Duke Carl Alexander.

The couple lived there for the next 12 years; Liszt conducted the local orchestra, taught piano pupils, and at last had substantial time to compose. Brilliant revisions of his earlier piano music from the Swiss and Italian years produced Romantic masterworks in the first two books of *Années de pèlerinage*, the *Etudes d'exécution transcendante*, and a religiously inspired piano cycle, *Harmonies poétiques et religieuses*. New creations included the Sonata in B minor and an ongoing sequence, *Hungarian Rhapsodies*. And with an orchestra now at his disposal, Liszt completed a cycle of 12 symphonic poems, plus his *Faust Symphony* and *Dante Symphony*, and a choral Mass written for the newly built cathedral in the Hungarian city of Esztergom.